

Physical Computing

Documentation & Sharing

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* Min res 56x16 char



Start early

- Take notes
- Take pictures
- Collect material
- From the beginning



Take notes

- TXT file per day
- ISO 8601 format date
- Sort alphabetically =>
sorted chronologically

* e.g. Notes_v20260616.txt

Take pictures

- Of everything
- The process
- The result



Clean up the set

- Reduce unnecessary clutter
- Arrange/uncurl/tame wires
- Remove unrelated tools



Show some context

- Hands for size reference
- Tools to hint at process
- Solder/cutting mat, etc.



Check the light

- Light from top left
- Shadow bottom right
- Single light source



Multiple perspectives

- Portrait and landscape
- Top view and front view
- Consider zooming out a bit



Keep many, select a few

- Selection depends on usage
- Often no way to go back
- Crop/rotate can help



Types of documentation

- Personal notes, research diary
- Photo collection / album
- Step-by-step tutorial
- Blog post / article
- Project repo
- Website
- Wiki



Sharing

- Discoverability
- URL as reference
- Encouraging reuse
- Collecting feedback

* e.g. HTML vs. PDF



Platforms

- Instructables
- Thingiverse
- GitHub/Lab
- Flickr

* and many others



Channels

- Local meetups
- Online groups
- Social media
- Platforms



Stay in control

- Enshittification is real
- Keep a copy on your disk
- Export tutorials as PDFs
- But also keep cost down,
e.g. for custom domains



Open (Source) Definition

- Free redistribution
- Includes source code
- Allows derived works
- No discrimination
- ...

* <https://opensource.org/osd>



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